

Chapter 136-3

Only after they finished bathing did Liang Shi get the bruise-healing ointment to apply on Xu Qingzhu.

While applying it, she even made Xu Qingzhu cry.

During those few days, Xu Qingzhu had an especially large amount of tears. She cried so much that before going to work the next day, Liang Shi had to ice her eyes.

After taking suppressants, an Omega's dependence on an Alpha would decrease.

But that was when there was no Alpha nearby. However, Liang Shi felt sorry for her, and aside from not feeding her meals, she wanted to do everything else for her. Even when Xu Qingzhu was going out and putting on shoes, Liang Shi would squat down to get her shoes from the shoe cabinet.

Xu Qingzhu felt embarrassed and wanted to do it herself.

But before she could even bend down, she had to hold her waist. Having been lying in bed for so long and having done so many things, even bending over had become a difficult, ache-inducing movement.

Liang Shi patted the top of her foot, "Don't try to be tough."

Xu Qingzhu glared at her, but without any intimidating effect whatsoever. Liang Shi just looked at her and smiled indulgently.

"I feel like I've become useless." Xu Qingzhu couldn't struggle free, so she stopped struggling and let Liang Shi put her shoes on for her, though her tone was slightly dejected.

But Liang Shi said: "Heat periods are a bodily characteristic. How does that make you useless?"

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

Afraid she would feel bad, Liang Shi half-squatted there and said self-deprecatingly: "If we're talking about being useless, it should be someone like me, right? I haven't worked in so long. Teacher Xu takes suppressants and still goes to work. Truly..."

She paused, just finishing putting on Xu Qingzhu's shoes, gently setting her feet down, then looked up and said word by word: "A role model for our generation."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

Xu Qingzhu stretched out her foot to kick her, but Liang Shi held it down.

Liang Shi's hand brushed past her ankle, stopping her: "Teacher Xu, you're wearing shoes."

Xu Qingzhu gave her a sidelong glance.

She had no choice but to give up.

She still remembered that night on the bay window, when the two of them just wanted to look at the scenery.

Looking at the melted snow on the road, looking at the water view of the Yu River—neither of them knew how things shifted in another direction.

Shifted in a direction neither could control.

There were clearly so many opportunities along the way to stop or turn back, but both of them let themselves indulge.

Liang Shi's sweat had soaked her temples. She asked Xu Qingzhu: "Is it beautiful outside?"

Xu Qingzhu's fingers were threaded through her hair, her voice choked: "Not as beautiful as you."

From midnight until dawn, when the distant sky turned the pale white of fish belly, they were both woken by the cold and only then returned to the bed.

Those sweet words Xu Qingzhu said during her heat period.

Even knowing they weren't entirely true, hearing them in the moment still made one's heart bloom with joy.

Liang Shi had never given Xu Qingzhu a cold face or gotten angry at her, even when she felt just a tiny bit that Xu Qingzhu was truly being unreasonable.

The next second, seeing her face and eyes, all the anger disappeared.

If she said one more coaxing word—just one.

Liang Shi would inevitably surrender quickly.

Facing Xu Qingzhu, how could she possibly get angry?

That day when the ringtone sounded, it was already late at night. Xu Qingzhu's crying had turned into soft sobbing, and Liang Shi's voice was also hoarse.

That ringtone broke the peaceful quiet of the room, ringing again and again.

Liang Shi was about to get up to fetch Xu Qingzhu's phone, but Xu Qingzhu wouldn't let her.

Before she could leave, Xu Qingzhu looked at her with grievance, "Jiejie~"

With her unique pacing and unique tone, she called out those two characters lingeringly, making one's heart tremble and legs go weak.

Almost without hesitation, Liang Shi turned back to the bay window.

Letting the ringtone sound in the room.

That ringtone rang again and again.

The next morning when they were both awake, Xu Qingzhu finally checked her phone and found it was an unknown number.

She called back, and it turned out the other party had dialed the wrong number.

It gave Liang Shi a false alarm—she had thought their absurdity had delayed something important for Xu Qingzhu.

When Liang Shi said this, Xu Qingzhu's brow furrowed slightly. Having just showered, her hair was still wet and hung down her back, covering her beautiful butterfly bones.¹

And the red marks on the side of her shoulder were very obvious.

Liang Shi sighed softly: "That's right. At the time, I was thinking it might be someone from the company looking for you."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

After a moment, Xu Qingzhu said faintly: "You were actually thinking about so much?"

Liang Shi: "...Huh?"

That astonished tone seemed to say—what else would I be thinking about?

Xu Qingzhu clicked her tongue: "Jiejie~"

Her wet hair brushed lightly across Liang Shi's leg like the wind. Liang Shi was about to say she would get her a towel to dry it, but Xu Qingzhu said leisurely: "It seems my charm isn't enough, that jiejie still had the mental energy to spare at times like that."

Liang Shi: "?"

Liang Shi was amused by her, "You don't know whether you have charm or not?"

Xu Qingzhu shook her head, her gaze clear, actually looking somewhat bewildered.

But if you looked carefully, you could see the craftiness in the depths of her eyes.

Liang Shi lowered her head and said by her ear: "These past few days I've nearly died with you in bed, and you still think you don't have charm?"

Hearing this, Xu Qingzhu laughed, the corners of her mouth curving into a brilliant arc as she raised her hand to cover her eyes full of mirth.

Xu Qingzhu turned and hugged her waist, nuzzling her head in her embrace.

Like a cat acting spoiled.

"Then do you not like it?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi: "....."

A long time passed—so long that Xu Qingzhu, whose emotions were unpredictable during heat, got angry, angry enough to bite her abs through her clothes.

Only then did Liang Shi stroke her hair and say: "I like it."

During those few days, just drying her hair alone, Liang Shi had done it many times.

Who knows how many baths they took in a single day.

After sending Xu Qingzhu to the company, she didn't have much time to herself either. She had to reorganize things at home and tidy everything up.

Then go greet the people who knew about her coma, and very soon it would be time for Xu Qingzhu to get off work.

Footnotes:

¹ Butterfly bones (蝴蝶骨) - A Chinese term for the shoulder blades (scapulae). When they protrude slightly, they're said to resemble butterfly wings and are considered an attractive feature in Chinese beauty standards.